AI Use Disclosure

Project: Ephemeral Feeds
Course: CM523 Interactive Web Design, 2025
This document discloses all areas in which AI assistance (Claude, Anthropic) was used during the development of this project. AI was used as a collaborative tool to refine and implement ideas that originated from the designer's own concept, design documentation, and wireframes. All creative direction, game concept, narrative framing, and visual language were authored by the designer independently.

CSS — Visual Refinement (style.css, about.html)

AI was used to help implement and systematise visual decisions across the stylesheet, guided by the designer's existing design intent.
Typography
Unified font sizing and weight hierarchies across all text layers — intro overlay, background news layer, platform labels, and score display. AI helped translate the designer's intentions from the design document into consistent clamp() values and rem-based scales that respond across screen sizes.
Colour & Brightness
Adjusted the brightness and opacity of multiple UI layers to improve legibility without disrupting the visual atmosphere. This included calibrating the background news layer opacity, the intro overlay translucency, and ensuring sufficient contrast between foreground game elements and the dark background.
Layer Separation
Refined the z-index hierarchy and visual treatment of the three main layers — intro overlay, background information layer (#background-layer), and the interactive game layer (#game-world) — to make each layer visually distinct while maintaining compositional coherence.
Glow & Animation Effects
Assisted in implementing the glow effects on the player character (white ambient glow, orange stomp flash) and active platforms (colour-matched box-shadow). Also refined the glitch-jitter keyframe animation on fake-news platforms and the shatter disintegration effect.

JavaScript — Game Logic & Physics (script.js)

AI was used to help implement, debug, and refine the game's physics behaviour and interaction model. The designer specified the intended feel and mechanics; AI translated these into working code and handled edge cases.
Jump Physics
Reworked the jump implementation to feel more physically intuitive — applying an upward impulse via Body.setVelocity() rather than direct position manipulation, producing a more natural arc. Gravity was tuned (Matter.js engine.gravity.y = 1.1) to match the intended pacing.
Anti-Consecutive-Jump Hold Prevention

Implemented a spacePressed flag to prevent the player from triggering multiple jumps by holding the Space key. A jump is only registered on the initial keydown event and is consumed once the jump executes, requiring the key to be released before another jump can be queued.

Stomp vs. Jump Distinction

Designed and implemented the two-press air mechanic that clearly separates a normal jump from a deliberate stomp: the first Space press in the air records a timestamp (airPressTime); a second press within 350 ms triggers the downward stomp velocity (y: +25) and the isStomping state. This prevents accidental stomps while making intentional ones feel deliberate.

Mid-Air Movement Lock During Respawn

Added an isRespawning flag that disables the character's automatic horizontal movement during the fall phase after respawning. This prevents the character from sliding off safe platforms before the player regains control.

Platform Generation Gap Control

Refined the procedural map generation in extendMap() to control horizontal gap size (250–470px) and vertical displacement limits separately for real vs. fake platforms — fake platforms are capped to a smaller upward offset to keep them reachable but distinct. Mobile and desktop Y-ranges are handled separately to account for viewport height differences.

Stomp Lock After Landing

Added a stompLocked flag that prevents the stomp state from re-triggering immediately after a successful stomp bounce. The lock is only released once the character lands on a surface again, ensuring the bounce arc completes cleanly.

Automatic Character Advance

Implemented the auto-run behaviour by directly writing to playerBody.velocity.x and playerBody.positionPrev.x each frame rather than using Body.setVelocity(), which would overwrite the vertical velocity and break the physics integration.

About Page Layout (about.html)

AI was used to help implement the about page layout to match the designer's visual design draft.

Page Structure & Typography Hierarchy

Translated the designer's layout concept into a single-column editorial structure with distinct typographic roles: large display heading (h1), monospace label tags (.label), lead sentences (.lead), and body paragraphs (.body-text). Font sizes, weights, and letter-spacing were tuned to reflect the design draft's visual intent.